

- An agent without tools is just a smart assistant, but an agent with tools becomes a system.
- Tool calling is what allows an AI agent to do things, not just say things.



What Is Tool Calling?

Tool calling allows an AI agent to:

- Decide **when** it needs external data or capabilities
- Select the **right tool**
- Pass structured inputs to that tool
- Receive structured outputs back

From the agent's perspective, tools are simply **capabilities** it can invoke when the task requires it.

Best Practices

- Don't over-tool agents
- Be explicit in instructions
- Start simple with configured tools
- Test before publishing

Common Pitfalls



- Expecting automatic tool usage
- Overloading the agent with tools
- Skipping output validation